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Domain Separation

Domain separation enables customers to separate data, processes, and administrative tasks into logically defined domains. Domain separation is the way to provide multi-tenancy support while only officially having one ServiceNow instance.

Key factors for selecting the architecture

The architectural model is the foundation for success with ServiceNow. it is critical to get the best architecture fit for the requirements before development starts. Consider the following key factors when selecting the architecture.

- Data
- Process
- Manageability
- Performance and scalability
- Technical sustainability

Architecture models

- **Deliberate customization**: This is a very flexible model that leverages baseline capabilities to extend out of the box applications for complex business requirements.
- **Multiple instances**: This model involves multiple production instances of ServiceNow that are each purpose-built for a specific set of business needs.
- **Domain separation**: This model leverages out the of box functionality on a single instance of ServiceNow to enable data and process segregation appropriate for separate business lines and/or customers.

Dimensions of domain separation

Domain separation handles three main areas:

- Data: Customer A will not see Customer B's data, though the MSP provider may support multiple customers and provide global reporting.
- Process: Customer A's processes may differ from Customer B's though they share the same instance.
- UI: Customer A's forms and interface may have different layouts and branding.

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Domain separation implementation limitations

There are objects on which domain separation is not applicable.

- System dictionary
- ACL: User cannot have separate roles in each domain and hence ACL will work same in all domain
- Inbound email action
- Public pages
- Script include
- System Property
- Dictionary Entry override
- Instance scan does not work for domain separated instances

Domain separation workshop

Ask questions to develop a customer hierarchy, including strategy, security, governance, access, customers, and internal use considerations.

- Draw out the planned hierarchy
- Discuss data separation needs
- Discuss process separation need
- Discuss globally visible data and globally shared processes
- Determine MSP involvement and operation in the model
- Build and plan for the future not just current use case